



A RETURN TO WAR

Many of the ongoing tensions between countries that arose in the 19th century gained momentum in the 20th. The assassination of the Austrian archduke Franz Ferdinand by Serbian nationalists in 1914 sparked World War I, a global conflict that would reshape Europe.



1914 The Vienna system was swept away by the wave of nationalism that crossed Europe from the mid-19th century. Countries such as Italy and Germany were unified by the time Europe sat on the brink of war in 1914. However, at Versailles in 1919, the map would be redrawn yet again.

KEY

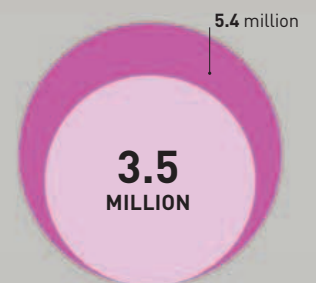
German Empire	Montenegro
Austro-Hungarian Empire	Portugal
Russian Empire	Romania
Netherlands	Italy
France	Greece
United Kingdom	Ottoman Empire
Norway	Albania
Spain	Luxembourg
Switzerland	Denmark
Sweden	Serbia
Belgium	Bulgaria

“ ANY **PLAN** CONCEIVED IN MODERATION **MUST FAIL** WHEN THE **CIRCUMSTANCES** ARE SET IN THE EXTREMES. ”

Prince Klemens von Metternich (1773–1859), Austrian foreign minister



13:6 **Rival populations**
The population of the Allied countries at the outset of World War I was more than double the population of the Central Powers.



KEY
● Allied Powers: Russia, France, Britain, Belgium, and Serbia
● Germany and Austria-Hungary
Troop numbers
The Allied Powers had far greater forces to mobilize in 1914 than the armies of the Central Powers.